

breath control.

cantata

A **programmatic** piece, generally for solo voices, choir, and orchestra, designed to tell a story.

castrato (pl. castrati)

Literally “castrated” (Italian); a male singer castrated before puberty so as to retain his high **alto** or **soprano** voice. Castrati were especially popular in 17th- and early 18th-century Italian **opera**, but castration for the purposes of art was banned by the late 18th century.

chamber music

Pieces composed for small groups of two or more instruments, such as duets, trios, and quartets.

chord

A simultaneous combination of notes. The most frequently used are called “triads,” which consist of three distinct notes built on the first, third, and fifth notes of a **scale**. For example, in the **key** of C major the notes of the scale are C, D, E, F, G, A, and B; the C major triad consists of the notes C, E, and G.

chromatic

Literally “of color” (Latin), based on the **scale** of all 12